

Assessment task 1: Report on privacy attacks

Maximum Marks: 50 marks

Learning Objectives: this assignment helps students understand data breach and attack from a real case. Students can study the selected case from various perspectives, such as seriousness, damage, financial loss, and so on.

Team: 2-3 persons in a team.

Introduction:

Cybercrime is a profitable industry for attackers and continues to grow. Hackers seek personally identifiable information to steal money, compromise identities, or sell over the dark web. There were many data privacy breach cases in history which caused a huge loss for organisations and their clients.

In this assessment task, student teams will investigate a real-world privacy breach involving a corporate environment. They will evaluate the levels of privacy in terms of data breach. They are required to write a report to summarise those breaches. Students are required to write a case study about data privacy breach and attack. Students have the freedom to choose a famous data breach case in history which they are interested in.

In this case study, students are required to introduce the case including what the adversary's target is, what kind of information has been stolen, what kind of damage, and how much loss have been caused in this case. Students are also asked to introduce what kind of attack method has been used in this case, and give at least one reasonable suggestion or solution to the organisation, which can help the organisation to prevent this kind of attack. Moreover, students need to demonstrate what they have learned from this case.

Word limit: 2000 – 2500 words

Due: 11/09/2026, 11:59 pm, Friday

Rubric:

Criteria	Developing	Good	Very Good	Excellent
Introduction (5%)	Not clear introduction to the report and data breach at all.	Clear introduction to the report but not clear introduction to data breach.	Clear introduction to the report and clear introduction to data breach.	Very clear introduction to the report and clear introduction to data breach.
Case Introduction (40%)	Not clear introduction to case at all.	Clear introduction to the case but not clear introduction to breach method.	Clear introduction to the case and clear introduction to breach method, what kind of information has been stolen or damaged.	Very clear introduction to the case and clear introduction to breach method, what kind of information has been stolen or damaged.

Reasonable solution (30%)	Not a reasonable solution at all.	A reasonable solution but not detailed.	A reasonable and detailed solution.	More than one reasonable and detailed solutions.
Reflection (20%)	Not clear and deep reflection on what you learn from the case.	Clear but not deep reflection on what you learn from the case.	Clear and deep reflection on what you learn from the case.	Very clear and deep reflection on what you learn from the case.
Conclusion (5%)	Not clear conclusion for the report and the case at all.	Clear conclusion for the report but not clear conclusion for the case.	Clear conclusion for the report and the case.	Very clear conclusion for the report and the case.